

Chapter 2

Start with Your “Why?”

“If you don’t know where you are going, you’ll end up someplace else.” –Yogi Berra

Anyone who reads this book can achieve FI, and many can do it in a decade or less. You may have read the previous sentence with a bit of skepticism, or you may actually find the concept ridiculous. But take note that nowhere does it say achieving FI is easy. That's because it isn't easy! Achieving FI requires hard work—time, planning, dedication, perseverance, and a vision of realizing your effort. We profile people with vastly different backgrounds and stories, all of whom have done it or are in the process of doing it. They openly share their secrets.

Let's start with insights from Carl, who writes the blog *1500 Days to Freedom*. On the *Choose FI* podcast, Carl shared that in another interview someone asked him to share his philosophy about money. He pondered the question for several days before he was able to answer. Why was this question difficult for someone who writes a popular financial blog? He shared that it finally clicked: “The